



Set Up Your Own Property Tool.

A plain-English guide — no coding, and you never open or edit a single file. If you can install an app and copy-and-paste into a website, you can do this. We go one small step at a time and tell you exactly what you'll see after each one.

~15 min

start to finish

Double-click

no terminal, no code

Your PC

your data stays home

Your own private property-lookup tool, running on your computer — at the data companies' cost, with no software markup, no per-seat fees, and no credits that expire.

Three phases. You can stop after two.

Here's the entire journey before we start, so nothing is a surprise. You'll only ever **double-click** and **use your web browser** — never a command, never a file.

1

Install the engine — Windows only

WINDOWS

On **Windows**, install one free thing: **Python** — the "motor" OpenProp runs on. Two clicks and one checkbox. On a **Mac**, skip this entirely — the motor is already built in.

2

Turn OpenProp on

FREE

Double-click one file. OpenProp opens in your web browser. You can look up any U.S. address right away.

3

Add your data (the keys)

OPTIONAL

Owner names, values, equity, phone numbers, AI search — each is a "key" you paste into the app's Settings page. Add what you need.

You never touch code or files. After Phase 2, OpenProp already works — address, flood zone, and neighborhood income, free. Phase 3 is a menu you turn on inside the app, by pasting keys. There's no wrong order and nothing to break.

On a Mac? Start at Phase 2. Macs already have the engine built in, so Phase 1 is for Windows only — skip it. That makes the whole thing about **10 minutes** for you.

Install the engine

PHASE 1

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Windows only — one download, one checkbox, ~3 min.

Mac owners: skip this page.

On a Mac? You are already done with Phase 1. macOS ships with Python — the engine OpenProp runs on — already installed. Nothing to download, nothing to click. Turn the page to Phase 2.

1

Download Python

In your web browser, go to the address below and click the big yellow **Download Python** button at the top. Don't worry about the version number — whichever one it offers is the right one.

➤ python.org/downloads

What you'll see: a file downloading, with a name like `python-3.13.exe`, in your **Downloads** folder.

2

Run it — and tick the box

Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click the file you just downloaded. An installer window opens with two buttons and a couple of checkboxes at the bottom.

This is the one thing you must not miss. At the bottom of that window, tick "**Add python.exe to PATH**" **before** you click anything else. It's a small checkbox and it is easy to skip — but without it, OpenProp can't find the engine and won't start.

Then click **Install Now** and let it run. If Windows asks "Do you want to allow this app to make changes?", click **Yes**.

3

Close it

When it says **Setup was successful**, click **Close**. That's the whole phase — no account, no restart, nothing to leave running.

You're done when: the installer says **Setup was successful** and closes. Python now sits quietly in the background forever; you will never open it or think about it again.

Engine installed.

That's the only software you'll ever install for OpenProp. Turn the page and let's switch the tool on.

Turn OpenProp on

PHASE 2

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Download, unzip, double-click — it opens in your browser.
~5 min.

1

Download OpenProp

When you bought OpenProp you got a **download link** — on the page right after you paid, and again in your **email receipt**. Click it and choose **Save**. The file lands in your computer's **Downloads** folder.

What you'll see: a file named `openprop.zip` in your Downloads folder.

2

Unzip it

Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click `openprop.zip`. A folder named **openprop** appears. Drag that folder onto your **Desktop** so it's easy to find.

3

Double-click "Start OpenProp"

Open the **openprop** folder on your Desktop. Right there — not in any sub-folder — is the file for your computer. Double-click it:

Mac `Start OpenProp.command` · **Windows** `Start OpenProp.bat`

Mac may say "unidentified developer." If it blocks the file, **right-click** it → **Open** → **Open**. You only do this once, ever.

What you'll see: a black window opens and shows progress. **The first time takes a few minutes** while it builds your tool — this is normal. Leave the window; after this it starts in seconds.

4

Log in

Your browser opens by itself to your new tool. If it doesn't within a minute, open your browser and type this into the address bar:

➤ `localhost:8787`

In the **Password** box type the starting password, then click the green **Sign in** button:

Password `changeme`



You're in — that's the setup.

Look up any U.S. address now — location, flood zone, and income, all free. Start/stop anytime with the `Start OpenProp` / `Stop OpenProp` files; turn the page to add more.

Add your data — the keys

PHASE 3

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Optional. Each key unlocks more, and it's all done inside the app.



How to add any key — the same 3 clicks every time

1. In OpenProp, click **Settings** — the small link in the very **top-right corner**.
2. You'll see a labeled box for each key. **Paste** your key into the box with the matching name, then click the green **Save** button.
3. On the right, the "Active now" list shows a **green dot** ● next to whatever you just switched on. Done — no restart, ever.

One dropdown decides everything: "Primary property provider." It's on the same Settings page, and it must **match the key you pasted**. OpenProp ships set to **reapi** (RealEstateAPI). **If you went with RentCast, change it to **rentcast** and hit Save** — otherwise your key sits there unused and searches come back empty.

A note on "free" tiers: the free plans below are only for trying things — they cap out fast and will block you mid-search. For real work, use the paid usage (it's small — see the costs on the next page) so you're never rate-limited.



RentCast

~\$74/mo

Owner, property details, tax history — best for one address at a time

for 1,000 lookups

1. Go to **app.rentcast.io/app/api** and click **Sign In** → create an account (email or Google).
2. Click **Select Plan**. For real use pick a paid plan; to just try it, the free **Developer** plan gives 50 lookups.
3. Click **Create API Key**, name it anything, and **copy** the key.
4. In OpenProp: Settings → paste into **RentCast API key** → set **Primary property provider** to **rentcast** → **Save**.

⌚ ~5 min 💡 Free tier is 50/mo, then it blocks — a paid plan is ~7¢/lookup

⚠️ Don't forget the **provider dropdown**



Anthropic (Claude)

The AI: plain-English search, property briefs, lead scores, outreach drafts

~\$5–20/mo

pay as you go

1. Go to **console.anthropic.com** and sign up (email or Google), confirming your email.
2. Click **Billing** → add a card → **Buy credits** (the ~\$5 minimum). **Do this first** — the key won't work without credit.
3. Click **API Keys** → **Create Key**, then **copy it right away** (it's shown only once).
4. In OpenProp: Settings → paste into **Anthropic API key** → **Save**.

🕒 ~5 min



A few cents per AI action; you prepay and spend down slowly

Key starts with

sk-ant-



HUD & Census

Fair-market rents by bedroom + neighborhood median income

Free

real gov data

HUD (rents): at **huduser.gov/hudapi/public/register** make a free account and **tick the "Fair Market Rents" box**. Create a token, then Settings → **HUD FMR token**.

Census (income): at **api.census.gov/data/key_signup.html** fill the short form, then **click the activation link in the email**. Then Settings → **Census API key**.

🕒 ~10 min for both



HUD: must tick **Fair Market Rents**



Census: must **click the email link**



Apify (skip trace)

Find the owner's phone number and email from a property address

~10–20¢

per lookup

1. Go to **console.apify.com/sign-up**, sign up (email or Google), and **click the verification email**.
2. Click your **profile picture** (top-right) → **Settings** → **API & Integrations**, then copy your **Personal API token**.
3. In OpenProp Settings: set **Skip-trace vendor** = **apify**, paste the token into **Skip-trace API key** → **Save**.

🕒 ~4 min



You pay only when you pull a contact

Token starts with

apify_api_



RealEstateAPI

The list builder — equity, mortgage balance, foreclosure & lien flags on every row

Trial

then premium

1. Go to **realestateapi.com** and click **Start Free Trial**; sign up with your email. You may be asked to book a short call to switch your account on — that's normal.
2. Log in at **dashboard.realestateapi.com** → open the **Keys** section → copy your **API key**.
3. In OpenProp: Settings → paste into **RealEstateAPI key** → leave **Primary property provider** on **reapi** → **Save**.

🕒 ~5-10 min



The only key that makes **searching a whole area** work

⚠️ Great free trial, but ~\$600/mo to keep

Which keys do you actually need? It comes down to one question — **are you looking up addresses, or building lists?**

Looking up one address at a time: RentCast + Claude + the free HUD/Census data. Set the provider dropdown to **rentcast**. Add Apify when you want phone numbers.

Searching a whole zip and filtering by equity or distress: that's **RealEstateAPI**, and only RealEstateAPI. It's the one provider that returns owner, value, equity and foreclosure/lien flags on every row — a RentCast-backed area search comes back mostly blank, so those filters match nothing. Use the free trial to see if list-building is your business before you commit to the price.

What it really costs.

OpenProp itself is free — you only pay the data companies for what you use, at **their** price, with no markup. Here's an honest, slightly-high estimate so nothing surprises you.

RentCast — owner, property & tax

The core data. About 7¢ a lookup on a paid plan.

\$0–74

free to try · ~\$74/mo real use

Claude AI — search, briefs, scoring

A few cents per action, prepaid and spent down.

\$5–20

per month, as you use it

Skip trace — phone & email

Only when you pull a contact. ~10–20¢ each.

\$0–20

per month, usage-based

Rents · income · flood (HUD, Census, FEMA)

Real U.S. government data. No meaningful limits.

\$0

always free

RealEstateAPI — the list builder

Only needed to search a whole area. Generous trial; pricey to keep.

trial

~\$600/mo after

YOUR LIKELY BILL

Occasional (a few lookups a week) **~\$15–25/mo**

Active (hunting deals daily) **~\$90–110/mo**

...and you're paying the data companies directly
— at cost, no seats, no expiring credits.

THE USUAL SUBSCRIPTION TOOLS

\$100–200+/mo

A subscription forever, a marked-up price, per-seat fees, and skip-trace credits that expire if you don't use them.

Rule of thumb: only add the keys you'll actually use, and keep an eye on the spend meter at the top of the app. It caps paid calls at a limit you set in Settings.



FINTOK.NEWS

You own it now.

OpenProp runs on your computer, with your keys, showing your searches to no one. No subscription, no seat fee, no expiring credits. Start it any time by double-clicking **Start OpenProp** in the openprop folder.

It's private

Everything saves on your machine. Your lookups and notes never leave it.

It's yours

Keys are pasted in Settings and can be changed or removed anytime. No lock-in.

It's honest

You pay the data providers at cost — no markup, no expiring credits, no surprises.



FINTOK.NEWS

OpenProp — made to be owned, not rented.